

USER EXPERIENCE · 2026

# The Journey Layout

A Markdown-native, list-and-inline-code driven user-journey diagram.  
One layout, five variants — each answers a different question about  
the experience you're documenting.

SECTION 01

# Authoring · nested list + inline code.

## How to write a journey

**Sections** are top-level list items **Tasks** are nested list items

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**Actors** are inline-code `@name` tokens — appearance order drives the legend

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**Mood** is `:1` (pain) → `:5` (delight); default `:3` if omitted

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**Volume** is `+N` for the weighted variant — task width scales by this number

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The same five lines of Markdown render in any of the five variants —  
swap `journey` for `journey heatmap`, `journey curve`, etc.

SECTION 02

Classic · the default Mermaid look.

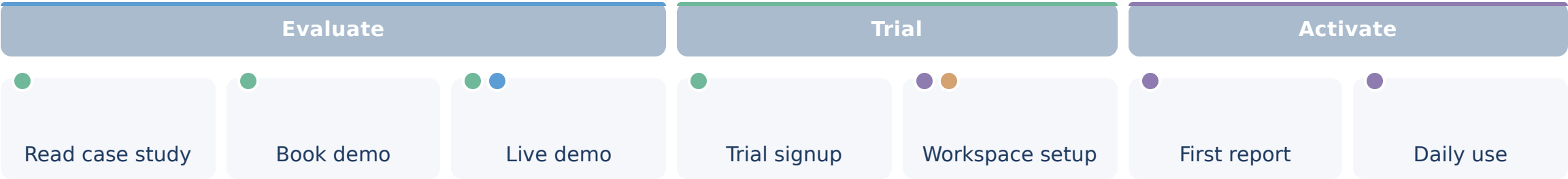
# Customer onboarding · trial → activation

**KEY INSIGHT**

**Setup is the chokepoint.** Mood drops three points between trial signup and first report — the only stretch we own end-to-end and the only place we can move conversion this quarter.

● prospect   ● sales   ● user   ● onboarding

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT



SECTION 03

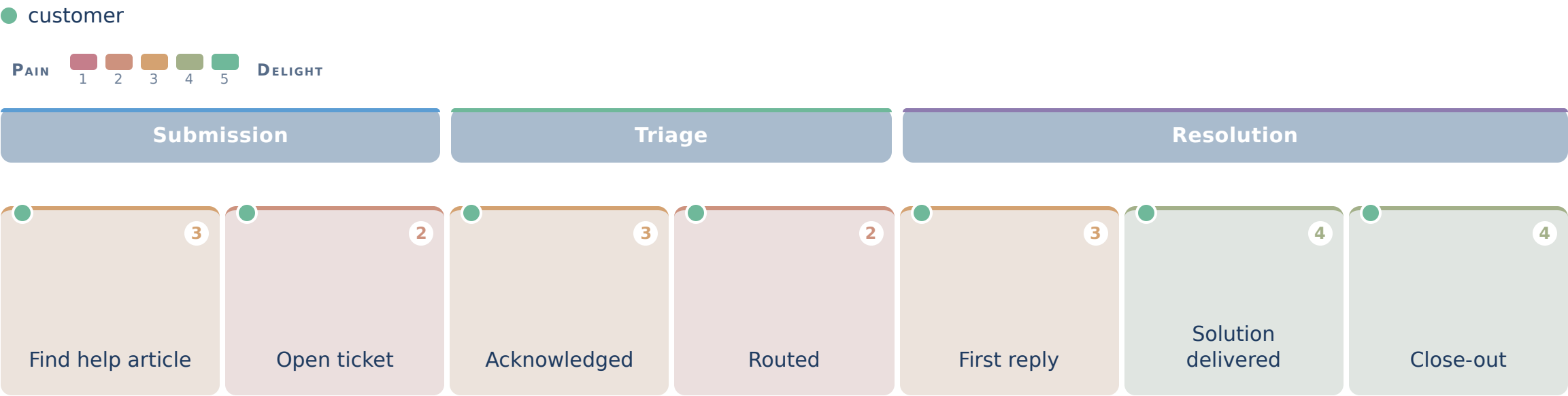
# Heatmap · friction at a glance.

# Support escalation · where customers cool off

KEY INSIGHT

**Routing latency, not solution quality, drives the orange band.**

Customers rate the resolution itself a 4 (Solution, Close-out), but mood stalls between acknowledge and route. Cutting that gap below four hours reclaims the dip.



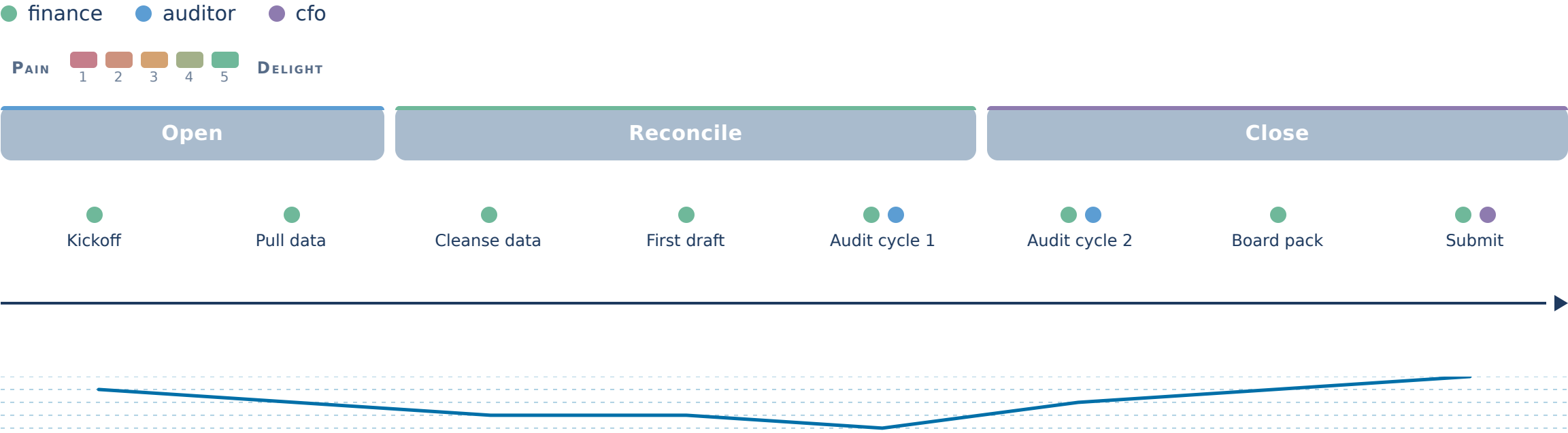
SECTION 04

Curve · the emotional arc.

# Quarterly close · the J-curve of the cycle

KEY INSIGHT

**The trough is the audit, not the math.** Close itself is technically straightforward; the dip is reconciliation rework and first-audit-pass surprises. Pre-audit prep is the cycle-time unlock.



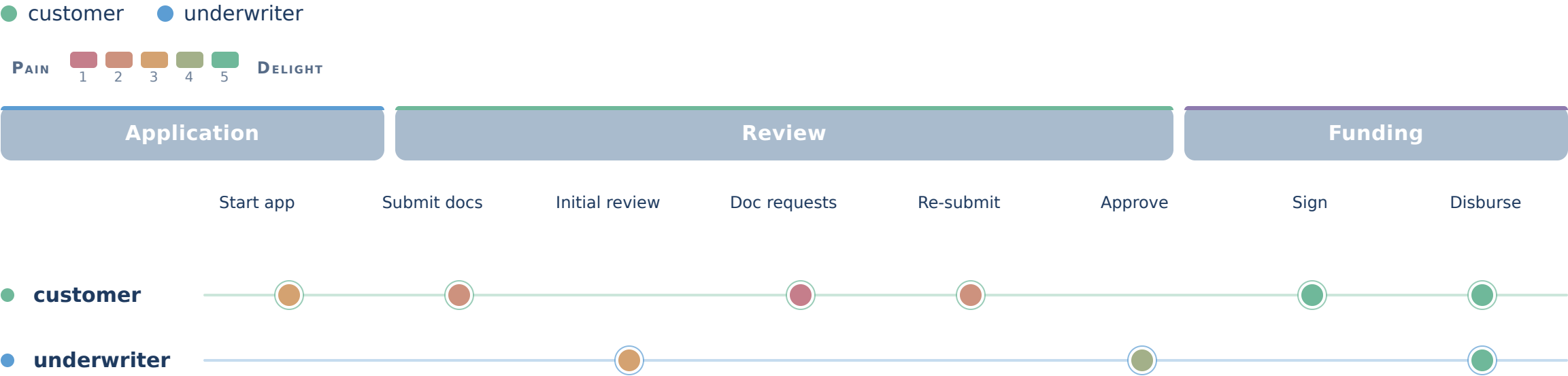
SECTION 05

# Swimlane · who feels what, where.

# Loan application · two perspectives diverge

**KEY INSIGHT**

**Customer pain peaks where underwriter mood holds.** Their lowest point — doc requests at mood 1 — is our steady state. NPS will trail underwriting efficiency until doc-request UX is fixed.



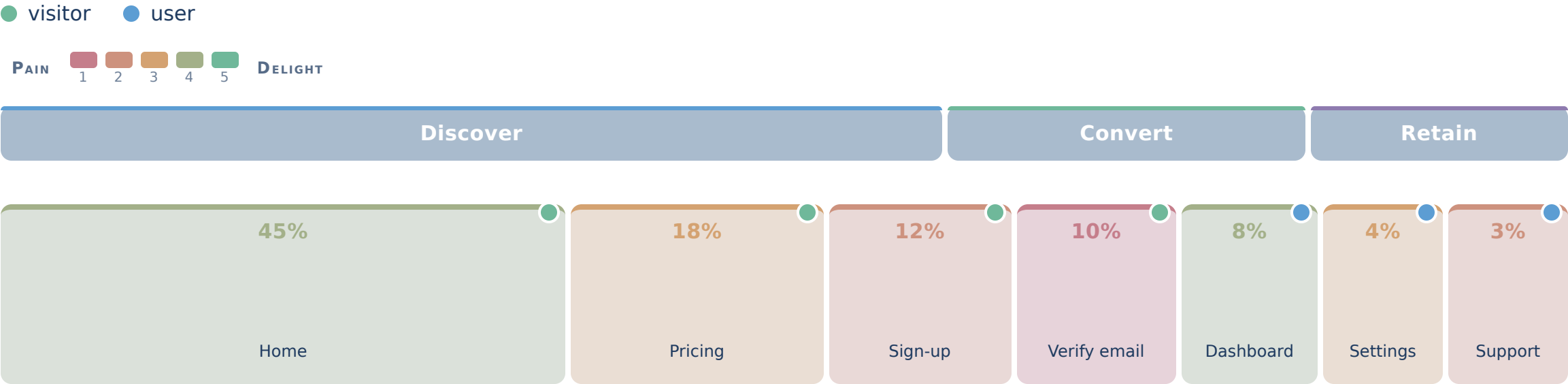
SECTION 06

**Weighted · volume × pain in one view.**

# Subscription funnel · prioritized by traffic × pain

KEY INSIGHT

**Verify is the highest-leverage fix.** 10% of traffic hits mood 1 at a single step we fully control. One week of work here outranks any home-page optimization on the roadmap.



SECTION 07

# Picking a variant.

## Which variant when?

**journey** — boardroom-familiar Mermaid look; lowest learning cost

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**journey heatmap** — fastest exec scan; "where are the red spots?"

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**journey curve** — narrative; "what's the shape of the experience?"

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**journey swimlane** — cross-functional; "who feels what, where?"

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**journey weighted** — decision-grade; "invest where pain × volume is highest"

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Default is **journey** (classic). All five variants accept the same authored Markdown — only the class changes.

USER JOURNEYS, THEMED AND TOKENIZED

# One layout · five views.

Same Markdown, same data, five distinct analytical reads. Picks up the active theme's palette through `--cat-*` tokens; mood ramp is `--journey-mood-1` ... `--journey-mood-5`.